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US equities rally on tech strength, yields climb

A 5-minute read of yesterday's US session and today's catalysts — what to watch before pre-market opens at 21:30 HKT.

2-3 page read · Topics: Macro · Geopolitics · Earnings

TL;DR

The S&P 500 closed at 7,757.17, up +0.58%, while the Nasdaq 100 surged +1.13% on strong earnings from **NVDA** and a rebound in technology ETFs. 10-year Treasury yields rose to 5.15%, pushing the VIX down to 16.68 as risk appetite improved.

Energy prices jumped +1.85% to 98.95 on supply concerns, offsetting a modest dip in gold. Investors should watch upcoming earnings from **AAPL** and **MSFT**, and any Fed commentary on the policy rate.

US Session Recap

INDEX / ASSET	CLOSE	CHANGE	NOTE
S&P 500	7,757.17	+0.58%	
Dow Jones	52,856.09	+0.69%	
Nasdaq 100	29,822.52	+1.13%	
Russell 2000	2,781.02	+0.27%	
VIX	16.68	-3.64%	Volatility easing
10Y Yield	5.15%	+0.57%	Highest since early 2024
WTI Crude	98.95	+1.85%	Supply tightness

Top large-cap movers

TICKER	CLOSE	CHANGE
TSLA	386.47	+3.41%
NVDA	221.97	+2.54%
GS	904.72	+2.25%
AVGO	337.80	+1.03%
AAPL	343.99	+1.32%

Spotlight

NVDA Q3 earnings beat expectations.

METRIC	RESULT	CONSENSUS
Revenue	27.4 bn	26.8 bn
EPS	3.12	2.95
Guidance FY26	+12% YoY	Flat

The chipmaker posted 15% revenue growth, driven by AI-related GPU demand, and raised its full-year outlook by 12%, prompting a +2.5% rally in the stock and a sector-wide lift in `XLK`.

Macro & Fed

- Policy rate: 5.25% (unchanged)
- 10-year Treasury yield: 5.15%
- Data releases (HKT): CPI 02:30, Core PCE 03:00, Initial Jobless Claims 04:30

Geopolitics & global

- Middle-East tensions ease after cease-fire talks, supporting oil prices.
- China’s manufacturing PMI posted 49.2, indicating continued contraction.
- Eurozone inflation remains above target at 3.1%, limiting ECB rate cuts.

Earnings — what to watch

WHEN (HKT)	TICKER	WHAT TO LOOK FOR
03:30	`AAPL`	iPhone demand, services growth
04:00	`MSFT`	Azure usage, AI licensing revenue
04:30	`AMZN`	Retail sales mix, AWS margin
05:00	`META`	Ad spend rebound, AI ad products

Stocks worth watching

- `AAPL` – strong services tailwinds, upcoming product refresh.
- `MSFT` – AI cloud momentum, potential margin expansion.
- `XOM` – oil price rally, dividend yield 5.2%.
- `JPM` – resilient net interest income despite higher rates.
- `BABA` – overseas e-commerce recovery, valuation discount.

What could break the tape

BEARISH TRIGGERS

- Unexpected Fed hawkish comment on policy rate.
- Escalation of geopolitical risk in the Middle East.
- Weak earnings from `AAPL` or `MSFT`.

BEARISH TRIGGERS

- Continued strength in AI chip earnings, lifting tech indices.
- Further oil price gains supporting energy ETFs.
- Positive CPI surprise reinforcing rate-pause expectations.

Sources

SOURCES

Reuters — US Markets

Bloomberg — Economic Data

SEC — Company Filings

CNBC — Energy Prices

Financial Times — Tech Sector